



Board Member at a Glance

Havana Specialist Hospital / a one-page reference for directors

The one idea: govern, don't manage.

The board sets direction, checks progress, and holds management to account. Management and Afya run the hospital day to day.

YOUR TWO HATS

- **In the room, wear the board hat.** Act for the whole company, both families, not a side or a department.
- **Keep board matters confidential.**
- **If you also run operations (the MD),** you report in, you do not chair. You cannot assure your own work.

HOW YOU STEER IN 4 MEETINGS A YEAR

- **Like a ship:** set the heading, read the dials, correct at intervals.
- **Management runs the moving parts** between meetings, within delegated limits.
- **Reporting brings the org to you;** committees go deeper between board meetings.

WHAT IT ASKS OF YOUR TIME

- **~1 to 2 days a month** once running; more early, and more if you chair.
- **4 board meetings a year** plus committees; read the pack, 2 to 4 hours, before each.
- **This sits on top** of your existing executive role.

THE ONE HABIT THAT MATTERS

- **Read the board pack before every meeting.** Block the time; note your questions.
- **A prepared director** contributes well and feels in control.
- **"Please explain that"** is one of the most useful sentences in any boardroom.

IF YOU CHAIR A COMMITTEE

- **Set the agenda** with the Company Secretary and management.
- **Run to time; hear everyone;** reach and record clear decisions.
- **You lead the conversation,** you are not the expert on everything in it.

QUESTIONS YOU CAN ALWAYS ASK

- **Why is this different from plan?**
- **Is it a one-off or a trend?** What is being done about it?
- **What would make it worse?** Asking the question is the governance.

CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

- **Declare it.** If it touches you, your family, or a connected business, say so.
- **Step out of it.** Leave the room for that decision (recusal).
- **Record it.** The Company Secretary keeps the register.

DISAGREEING WELL

- **Everyone is heard** before a decision is made.
- **Reasons are explained;** decide for what is best for HSH.
- **Once decided properly,** get behind it, together.

THE BOARD'S FOUR JOBS

Oversee the Afya partnership / Secure HSH long-term / Build credibility & influence / Protect both families